

# CLI and TUI Parameters (Step by Step)

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## About

This guide explains the command:

```
1 md2tex source.md -c -t ./utils/template.tex -o ./export/export.tex -d  
↪ book -u -f
```

and how to set the same options in the TUI.

## 1. Base input

```
1 md2tex source.md
```

- `source.md` is the required input Markdown file.
- It must exist and use `.md` extension.

TUI equivalent:

- Input Markdown File (\*.md) [required] = `source.md`

## 2. Build a complete TeX document

```
1 -c
```

- Enables complete TeX output (preamble + `\{\}\begin{document} + \{\}\end{document}` + TOC support).
- Without `-c`, output is body-only TeX content.

TUI equivalent:

- Enable Complete TeX file (`-c`)

### 3. Use a custom TeX template

```
1 -t ./utils/template.tex
```

- Uses a custom template instead of the bundled default template.
- The template must include `@@BODYTOKEN@@`.
- Common pattern: keep preamble/style in template and inject converted Markdown body at `@@BODYTOKEN@@`.

TUI equivalent:

- Template File (\*.tex) [optional] = `./utils/template.tex`

#### What is a template in md2tex?

A template is a complete `.tex` skeleton that `md2tex` uses as a wrapper around converted Markdown content.

Think of it as:

- Your LaTeX layout/style (preamble, fonts, margins, packages)
- Plus one placeholder where converted Markdown will be inserted

Required token:

- `@@BODYTOKEN@@` (mandatory): replaced with converted body content

Optional tokens supported by md2tex default flow:

- `@@DOCUMENTCLASSTOKEN@@`: replaced with `article` or `book`
- `@@TITLETOKEN@@`: replaced with the generated title page (if first Markdown heading is level 1)
- `@@CODEPACKAGES@@`: replaced with code package setup (`listings/minted + xcolor`) according to backend strategy

Minimal valid custom template example:

If `@@BODYTOKEN@@` is missing, conversion fails because `md2tex` has nowhere to inject the Markdown output.

```

1  \documentclass{@@DOCUMENTCLASSTOKEN@@}
2  @@CODEPACKAGES@@
3  \begin{document}
4  @@TITLETOKEN@@
5  @@BODYTOKEN@@
6  \end{document}

```

```

1  -o ./export/export.tex

```

## 4. Choose custom output path

- Writes output to `./export/export.tex`.
- If directory does not exist, it is created.
- If extension is missing, `.tex` is appended.

TUI equivalent:

- Output TeX File (\*.tex) [optional] = `./export/export.tex`

## 5. Select document class

```

1  -d book

```

- Sets TeX document class to `book`.
- Allowed values: `article` or `book`.
- Affects heading mapping (# as `\{\}\{chapter\}` in `book`, `\{\}\{section\}` in `article`).

TUI equivalent:

- `document_class` selector = `book`

## 6. Convert headings as unnumbered

- Uses unnumbered section commands (e.g., `\{\}\{chapter\}`, `\{\}\{section\}`).
- The converter still adds TOC entries with `\{\}\{addcontentsline`.

TUI equivalent:

- Enable Unnumbered headers (`-u`)

```
1 -u
```

## 7. Convert inline quotes to French quotes

```
1 -f
```

- Converts inline quoted text to `\{\}\{ }enquote{...}` (via `csquotes`).

TUI equivalent:

- Enable French quotes (`-f`)

### Full mapping summary

- CLI `source.md` -> TUI Input Markdown File
- CLI `-c` -> TUI Complete TeX file (`-c`)
- CLI `-t PATH` -> TUI Template File
- CLI `-o PATH` -> TUI Output TeX File
- CLI `-d book|article` -> TUI `document_class`
- CLI `-u` -> TUI Unnumbered headers (`-u`)
- CLI `-f` -> TUI French quotes (`-f`)

### Extra options you can also use

CLI:

```
1 --code-backend auto|minted|listings
2 --shell-escape
```

TUI equivalents:

- Enable `shell-escape` toggle
- Code backend is `auto` by default:
  - `shell-escape` enabled -> `minted`
  - `shell-escape` disabled -> `listings`

## Practical examples

1. Minimal conversion:

```
1 md2tex myfiles/example.md
```

1. Complete book with custom template and output:

```
1 md2tex myfiles/example.md -c -t ./templates/book.tex -o  
↪ ./build/notes.tex -d book -u -f
```

1. Force minted with shell-escape expectations:

```
1 md2tex myfiles/example.md -c --code-backend minted --shell-escape
```